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Let the shopping festivities begin !

Digit recently hosted a Festival Shopping Guide Webinar. Lots of Digit enthusiasts showed up to get invaluable street smarts for their festival shopping. The Digit team had tested, reviewed, compared and haggled with vendors across the country to bring them the greatest festival shopping guide. The highlight ? Agent 001 himself live with his sharp wit and insightful advice. Here's an excerpt of the transcript. Read on, maybe you can pickup some interesting buying tips!

Raaabo : Hi everyone, this is a CHAT ONLY meeting in order to protect Agent001's identity | Just type your question and don't forget to mention your budget, and Agent001 will respond in the chat |

Agent001 : Hey pop 'em questions my way :)

Achuth : I need help in buying a game controller, but the problem in my area is availability.

Agent001 : My default suggestion would be a wired X360 controller. It's built well, affordable (1400 bucks), enough buttons for 90% of games. I use one on my PC for Prince Of Persia.

Vineet : Hi. Welcome all.

Agent001 : Hey Vineet, can I help you with anything? Buying decisions...except firecrackers :)

Raaabo : Everyone's too busy Diwali shopping I guess :)

Vineet : Ok I have a question. Whats the best video cam I can afford?

Raaabo : What's your budget? Around 30 to 35K?

Agent001 : The two main questions you need to ask yourself are: HD or non HD? What choice of media?

Vineet : HD of course :)

Agent001 : If you want HD + HDD you will need to pay at least 32K

Raaabo : I would recommend an HD camcorder, with hard drive storage

Agent001 : Unless there are special schemes where you can get it for lower, tapes not worth it. They suffer from recurring costs, extra service charges, higher maintenance costs and more hassles with using and storing videos

Agent001 : HDD all the way!

Agent001 : Sony's XR100E is a good model.

Vineet : price?

Agent001 : 39K

Vineet : Wow that's huge

Raaabo : Vineet for about 2.5K a month on EMIs with a down payment of about 8K you can still get it.

Vineet : Wow that's good news

Kiran : can any 1 tell me what will be the cost of a 1TB internal hard drive?

Agent001 : Rs. 6200~7100, depending on the model.

Raaabo : You want storage or speed?

Agent001 : Storage = WD Green Edition. Speed = WD Black Edition

Agent001 : Seagate will be slightly cheaper, at around 700~1000 bucks. But to my knowledge, Seagate has reliability issues with their 1 TB drives; especially the 7200.12 series

Raaabo : I would recommend the 1.5 TB Seagate, I own one and no problems

Kiran : Wat should be minimum RAM capacity when using a 1TB HDD?

Agent001 : They are unrelated

Raaabo : RAM and HDD have nothing to do with each other

Kiran : Ok. Also what will be cost of a 19inch TFT? Any brand would do?

Raaabo : do NOT buy a 19-inch monitor, it's not worth it

Kiran : Why?

Agent001 : Because a 22 inch is available at 1~2K more.

Kiran : Which brand?

Agent001 : Viewsonic, Acer, Dell, Samsung, AOC -- take your pick.

Agent001 : AOC is very cheap and they won in our LCD test.



NOVEMBER 2009 digit events

Digit is taking interactivity to a new level, and will be organising events every month. You get to meet and interact with people that you wouldn't in the normal course of your life — industry experts, Team Digit, and other readers with similar interests. Stay updated and stay ahead of the curve by looking for this page in every month's magazine.

1 Career Webinar INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Intellectual Property Research and analytics is a fast growing industry in India. Understand what it takes to stay ahead of the curve: from challenges, and a global work experience to learning and growth opportunities. Nikhil Sharma, Head of Electronics and Communications division of Evalueserve's Intellectual Property team will give you an insider's perspective on this profession. Nikhil manages a team of 60 IPR professionals and for the past five years has been working with partners at law firms, CEOs, CTOs, heads of licencing, and R&D managers at Fortune 500 companies, across multiple continents, to advise them on innovation, IP protection strategy, technology licencing and commercialisation. Send in specific questions before the webinar to careertalks@thinkdigit.com with a subject line "IP".

NOVEMBER 13
TIME: 1500 HRS

2 Webinar SYSTEM TROUBLESHOOTING

Get simple troubleshooting solutions for common system niggles from the Digit team. From repairing your infected flash drives to recovering system files using a Windows installation disk, we'll cover it all. Also don't miss out on other topics such as scheduling a disk image, creating ghost images, manipulating registry entries and recovering data from a crashed hard drive by using simple work arounds. The floor is open; ask your queries and have them solved live!

NOVEMBER 14
TIME: 1600 HRS

For details on upcoming webinars and to view past webinars, visit thinkdigit.com/webinars